

Lucas Howard

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Summary

Cybersecurity professional with expertise in data engineering, cloud analytics, and threat intelligence. Skilled in automating incident response workflows and transforming unstructured data into actionable security insights using Python, Spark, and Databricks. Adept at architecting scalable, secure data pipelines that strengthen incident response and bridge the gap between cyber defense and advanced analytics.

Education

MS	Western Governors University , Cybersecurity and Information Assurance • Excellence Award for Secure Network Design	Sept 2023 – July 2024
BS	Western Governors University , Cybersecurity and Information Assurance	Sept 2022 – Feb 2023
AS	Guilford County Community College , Cybersecurity and Information Assurance	Jan 2019 – Dec 2020

Experience

Nike, Inc. , Senior Cyber Defense Incident Data Analyst	Remote Jan 2023 – present
• Conducted incident impact analyses that directly determined escalation to the CISO, shaping executive-level decision-making. • Built a shared Python package with CI/CD pipelines and unit testing, ensuring production reliability and standardization across the incident analysis team. • Developed automated reporting tools using Docker, JupyterLab, and Quarto, cutting incident report prep time by 50%. • Mentored teammates via weekly technical training on Python, GitHub, and software development standards, boosting team proficiency. • Championed integration of Databricks notebooks into credential stuffing workflows, replacing AWS EMR for advanced analytics. • Streamlined log analysis with a risk-based approach, reducing manual data review requirements by 90%. • Partnered with CSIRT to onboard Palo Alto XSOAR, automating incident action plan workflows and saving 20+ hours per incident. • Migrated Cyber Defense metrics from PostgreSQL to Databricks using Delta Lake tables, modernizing the data pipeline and improving scalability. • Transitioned reporting dashboards from Grafana to Tableau, enhancing executive visibility and enabling advanced analytics for leadership. • Collaborated with the Network Security team and Cyber Defense Center to develop an automated pipeline that identified risky shadow IT applications (e.g., unauthorized VPNs and remote access tools), strengthening enterprise security posture.	
Nike, Inc. , Cyber Defense Data Analyst	Remote Oct 2021 – Jan 2023
• Designed and delivered Grafana dashboards used by the CISO and VPs, enabling executive visibility into cybersecurity metrics. • Optimized PySpark jobs on AWS EMR, halving data collection times for credential stuffing incidents and improving SOC agility. • Collaborated across departments to refine Vulnerability Management metrics, strengthening Nike's cybersecurity framework.	

L&E Research, Director of IT/AV and Security

- Implemented Qualys vulnerability management, Microsoft MDM, and Azure AD, modernizing endpoint and identity security across 200+ devices.
- Deployed KnowBe4 phishing simulations and training, reducing company-wide phishing susceptibility by 50%.
- Developed automated onboarding/offboarding workflows with Jira and Azure AD, streamlining account lifecycle management for 300 employees.
- Introduced and administered Jira and Confluence, improving IT workflow tracking, documentation, and cross-departmental collaboration.
- Designed and deployed a secure cloud video recording platform on AWS Media Services, safeguarding sensitive market research data.

Raleigh, NC
July 2019 – Oct 2021

North Carolina National Guard, B Battery, 5-113th Field Artillery, 25B Information Technology Specialist

- Supported Operation Inherent Resolve (Aug 2018 - Jul 2019), managing secure communication networks and resolving technical issues under high-pressure conditions.
- Automated access request workflows with a custom Python script, streamlining processes for 120+ military personnel.
- Honored with highest rank achieved: E4 Specialist (SPC).

Various
June 2014 – June 2022

XPO Logistics, Network Administrator

- Built internal web-based tools for network configuration, reducing deployment time.
- Managed Cisco routers/switches and enhanced network segmentation and monitoring.

High Point, NC
Mar 2018 – Aug 2018

Certifications

- Advanced Security & Cloud: CISSP, CCSP, CISM, CIPT
- Networking & Operations: CCNA, Cisco CyberOps Associate, AWS Solutions Architect – Associate, Microsoft Azure Fundamentals, ITIL Foundation
- CompTIA Suite: A+, Network+, Security+, Cloud+, Project+, Linux+, Server+, Pentest+, CySA+, SecurityX

Technologies

Data Engineering: Python, SQL, Pandas, Pyspark, Jupyter Notebooks, Databricks, Snowflake, Grafana, Tableau

Security Tools: Splunk, Qualys, Sophos Endpoint Protection, KnowBe4, Azure AD, Microsoft MDM, AWS Security Services (IAM, KMS, CloudTrail)

Cloud & Infra: Docker, Databricks, Snowflake, Grafana, AWS, Azure

Collaboration & Workflow: Git/GitHub, Jira, Confluence, Agile/Scrum

Skills

- Security & Technical: Incident Response & Management, Threat Analysis, Security Automation, Application Security, Vulnerability Management, Cloud Security (AWS & Azure)
- Tools & Systems: Windows & macOS Administration, SIEM & Log Analysis, Secure Network Design
- Professional Strengths: Strong Verbal & Written Communication, Cross-Team Collaboration, Mentorship & Knowledge Sharing, Detail-Oriented Execution, Proactive Security Control Improvement